automatically mean that both sides had also established formal diplomatic relations. This led the Government of India to believe that there would still be time and opportunities after the recognition of the new regime, to raise matters of concern or pursue national security objectives through diplomatic channels. In other words, whereas the Chinese saw the process of recognition as a matter of substantive negotiation, India considered it simply a matter of protocol. The idea was to win Chinese goodwill as soon as possible. The assumption that China also saw recognition as a routine matter was not based on facts or solid evidence. It might have been prudent to at least gauge the Chinese thinking in this regard. India had the means to do so because the Government had shown foresight in retaining some of the Indian diplomats in China even after the collapse of the Nationalist government, precisely in order to establish contact with the new regime. Despite this, the services of A.K. Sen, India's chief liaison officer in Nanking, were not enlisted in ascertaining Chinese thinking and expectations. Had Sen done that, India might have realized that China regarded the act of official recognition as a distinct process from the subsequent act of formal establishment of diplomatic relations. India might then have adopted a very different strategy.

The lapses on India's part—the absence of wider political consultations within the Indian leadership, the overlooking of its national interest in its anxiety over the timing, and the erroneous assumption that the act of officially recognizing the People's Republic of China was tantamount to the automatic establishment of formal diplomatic relations—led the Government of India to see the act of recognition as its only objective. In the process, India unilaterally gave up some crucial negotiating cards. First, India severed ties with the Nationalist government in Taiwan. The Prime Minister directed the Foreign